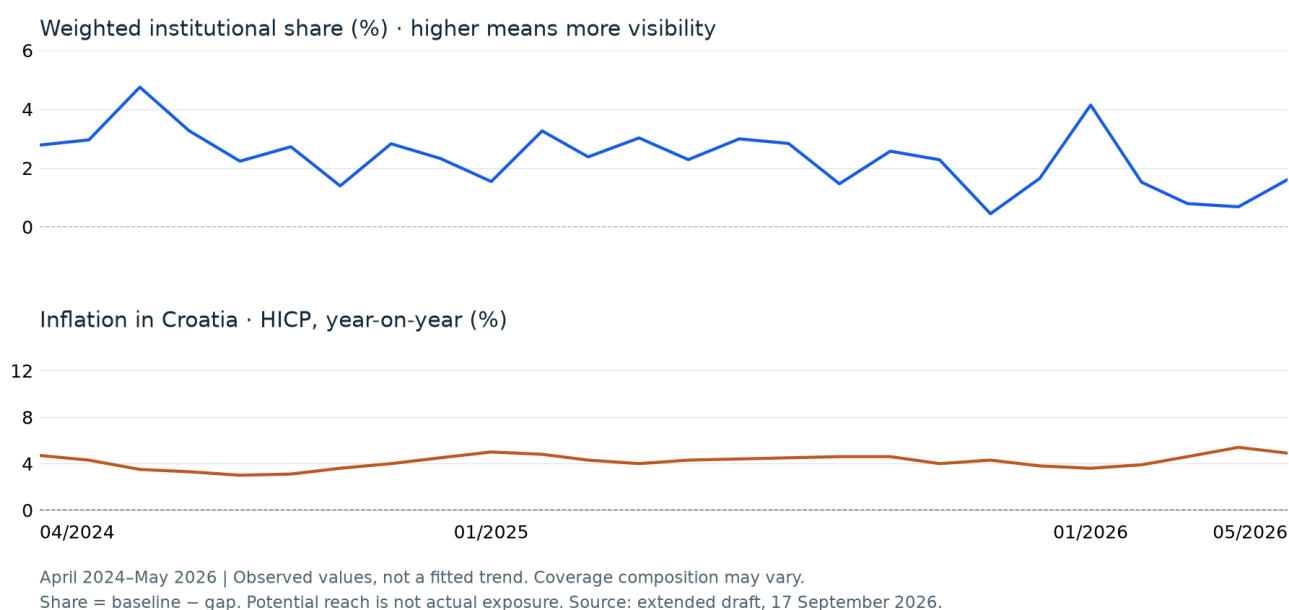


HNB in Croatia's inflation debate

How visible is the central bank when inflation dominates the news?

Counting institutional publications tells us what was issued. Media analysis adds evidence about representation in the wider debate. A focused extension could examine which explanations are carried, through which channels, and how accurately.

The measure, intuitively. The weighted share accounts for institutional prominence and potential reach. Hypothetically: a 4% baseline minus a 3% current share gives a +1 percentage point gap. A larger gap means a smaller share. This is not a share of people or a simple percentage of articles.



1. Higher inflation accompanies lower visibility. A 1 pp higher inflation rate is associated with a 0.21 pp wider gap (95% CI 0.11 to 0.31; 268 weeks). The primary model includes media volume. Precision depends on time controls.

2. Visibility declines within the later period. The controlled gap trend is +0.076 pp per month (95% CI 0.035 to 0.118; 25 months). A positive trend also appears among common sources. Coverage composition may change.

3. A stable expectations link is not established. Results depend on how the monthly survey is assigned to weeks and which controls are used. Some horizons are significant; visibility does not measure understanding or trust.

From evidence to an applied pilot

Institutional explanation → media representation → exposure and understanding → expectations and decisions.

This is a conceptual pathway, not an estimated causal chain. The current study measures media representation. The objective is understanding how information travels, not maximising institutional mentions.

PROPOSED RESEARCH

How are selected monetary-policy explanations represented in Croatian media? Agree a small set of communications, a time window and the decision the analysis should inform.

1. Validate measurement. Distinguish HNB, ECB/Eurosystem, other and ambiguous references. Output: an attribution, coverage and reliability audit.

2. Trace explanations. Compare source communications with media items, using human validation. Output: message-uptake case studies by channel and a validated analytical dataset.

3. Inform the next decision. Output: an executive assessment and a recommendation on whether recurring monitoring or separate audience research is justified.

This is a proposed extension, not completed analysis. Message fidelity and validated attribution have not yet been measured. Scope, data access, effort and price would be agreed separately. A briefing of existing findings can be an initial engagement.

ESSENTIAL INTERPRETATION LIMITS

Primary sample: January 2021-May 2026; 62 usable months / 270 weeks, with 60 / 268 observations in the main regressions. January-March 2024 is excluded monthly; the complete week from 1 January remains included. Levels across the April 2024 collection change are not harmonised.

The selected corpus is not a representative audience sample. Generic terms can capture other central banks. Potential reach is not exposure; sentiment lacks independent validation. No causal effect on beliefs is established. Earlier reported and recalculated coefficients do not fully agree; exact earlier-paper replication remains unresolved.

AUTHORS AND SOURCE

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Independent draft of 17 September 2026; not an HNB publication. Findings were matched to saved outputs; models were not re-estimated. Source: sections 4.2, 4.5, 4.6 and Appendix A23.

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